Q19: Discussion Questions

DLS 2026 — Kukla

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1. If an LLM's claim to be conscious is caused by its training data, is there *any* verbal behavior that would count as evidence of experience? Specify it or argue none exists.

2. IIT implies a purely feed-forward network has $\Phi = 0$ no matter how it behaves, while a simple recurrent circuit can have $\Phi > 0$. Is this a strength or a fatal flaw of the theory? Defend a view.

3. The "gaming" problem says any named behavioral sign can be faked by a capable system. Does this doom all empirical tests, or only behavioral ones? What survives?

4. Suppose two reputable theories disagree on whether a given system is conscious. How should a policymaker act under that uncertainty—and does the moral cost of being wrong change the answer?

5. Distinguish access consciousness from phenomenal consciousness with a concrete AI example where a system clearly has one but arguably not the other.